Drinking Water access in Afghanistan

UNICEF MICS 2022–23 | Population using at least basic drinking water services

Households in survey sample

23213

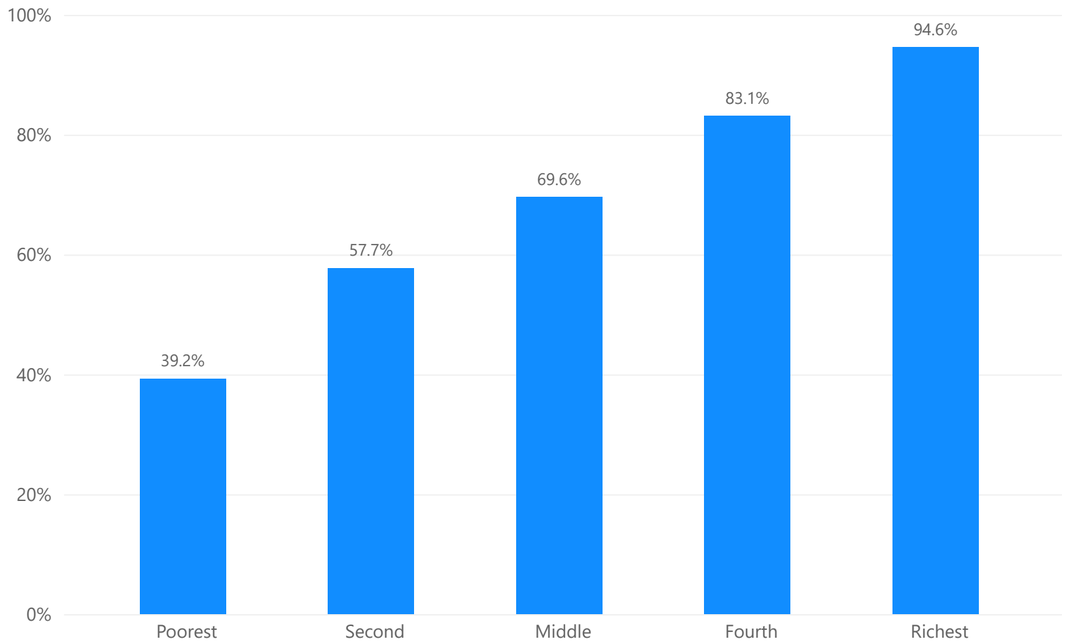
Population with at least basic drinking water

68.84%

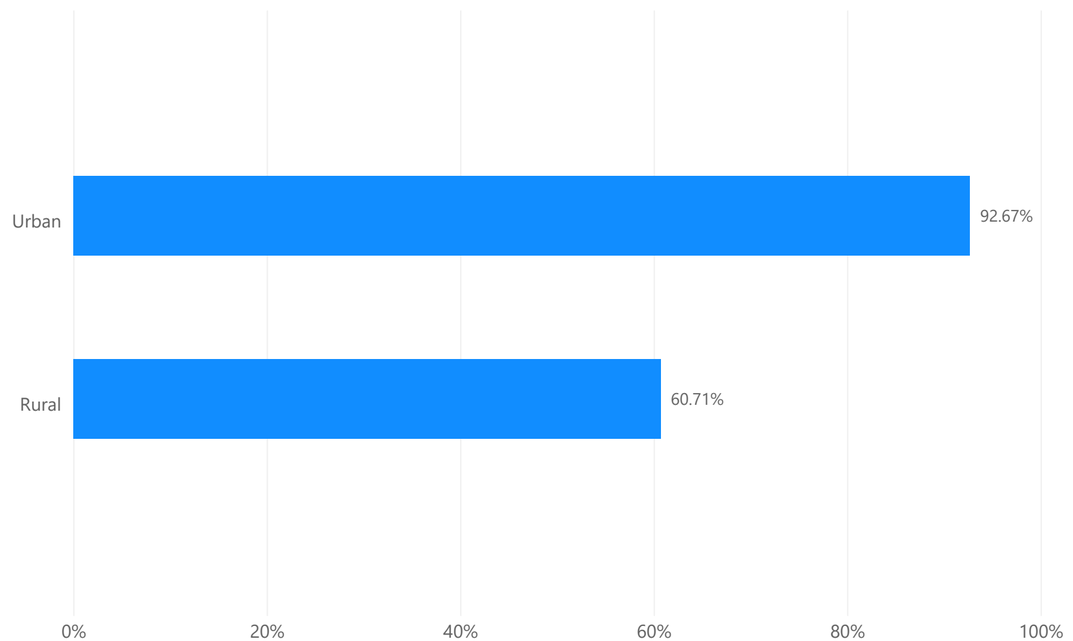
Residence

- ☐ Rural
- ☐ Urban

Population using at least basic drinking water, by wealth.

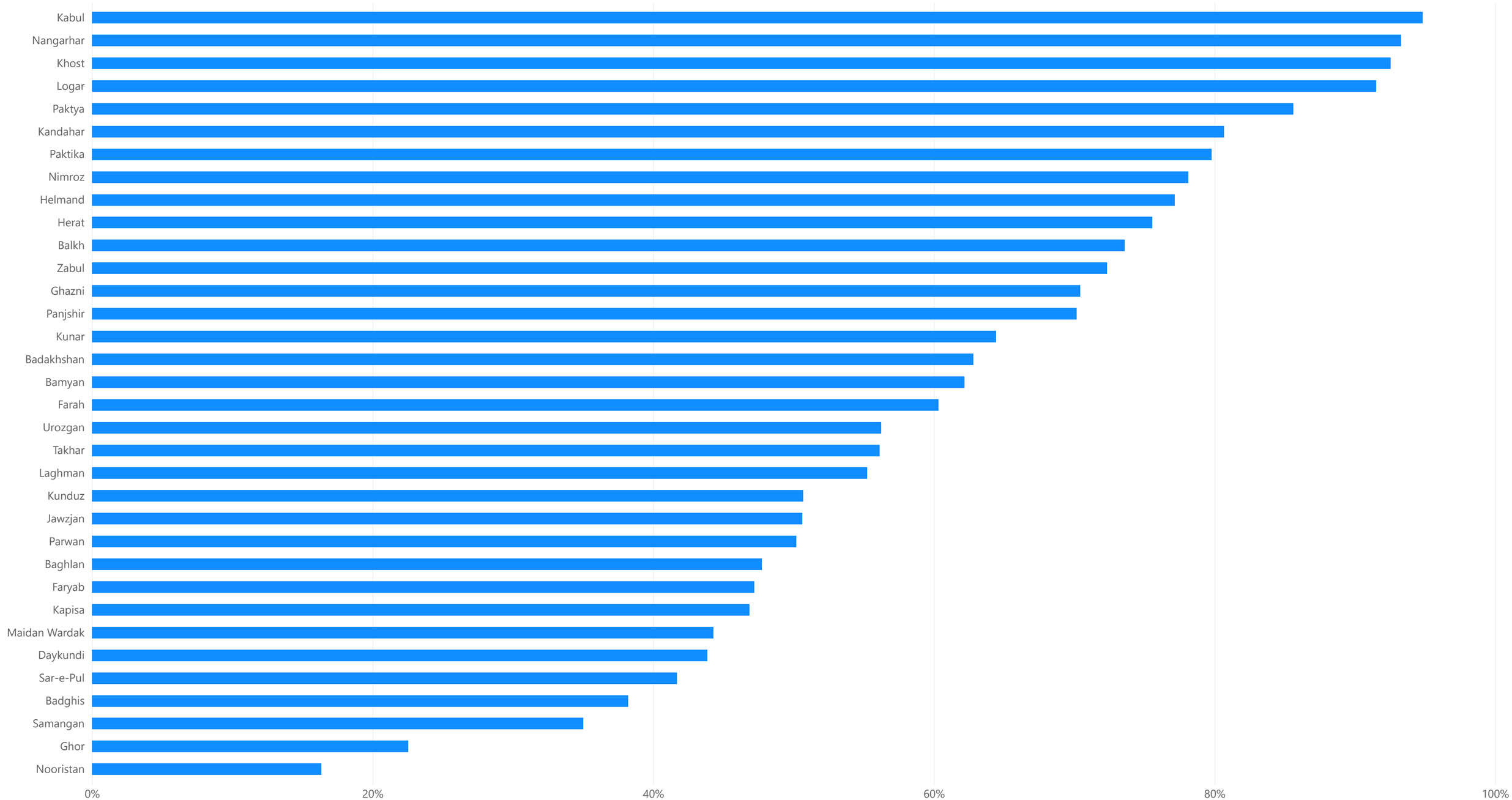


Population using at least basic drinking water, by residence.



Percentages use household weight × household size. See Methodology for classification rules and Validation for checks.

Population using at least basic drinking water, by province.



Drinking water access in Afghanistan

MICS 2022–23 · Population-weighted estimates · All filters cleared.

National access
An estimated **68.84%** of people lived in households using at least basic drinking water services.

Residence difference
Access was **92.67% in urban areas** and **60.71% in rural areas**, a difference of **31.96 percentage points**.

Wealth difference
Access increased across wealth groups, from **39.25% among the poorest** to **94.59% among the richest**, a difference of **55.34 percentage points**.

Province differences
Kabul had the highest observed estimate at **94.81%**, followed by Nangarhar at **93.29%** and Khost at **92.53%**. The lowest were Nooristan at **16.34%**, Ghor at **22.52%**, and Samangan at **35.00%**.

Further investigation
The results identify rural communities, poorer households, and low-access provinces for closer investigation. Assessing interventions would require additional evidence about local infrastructure, reliability, affordability, and water quality.

Descriptive survey estimates. Sampling uncertainty has not been calculated; differences do not establish causes.

Data and scope
UNICEF Afghanistan MICS 2022–23. The analysis includes 23,213 completed household interviews.

At least basic drinking water
An improved drinking water source that is on the household's premises or requires no more than 30 minutes for a round trip, including queuing. Improved sources include piped water, boreholes, protected wells and springs, rainwater, and packaged or delivered water.

Calculation
Each household contributes hhweight × HH48, where HH48 is household size. The percentage equals the population-weight sum for households meeting the indicator divided by the population-weight sum for all completed households.

Classification decisions
Households reporting no collection are included in the ≤30-minute category. Recorded WS2 answers help identify on-premises access for packaged-water households. "Other source" is classified as unimproved. Unresolved source or collection-time responses remain in the denominator and contribute zero to the indicator numerator.

Validation
All household weights are positive. The household-weight sum is 23,213.00. The national result of 68.84%, Urban result of 92.67%, and Rural result of 60.71% match UNICEF's published figures when rounded to one decimal place.

Limitations
The calculation adapts published Serbia MICS6 syntax to Afghanistan's source codes. Agreement with published totals supports validation but does not verify every individual record. Improved sources are classified by their design; water-quality testing is not part of this indicator. Confidence intervals and statistical significance were not calculated.